TOPIC 4 · CREATE A PROFESSIONAL PRESENTATION WITH POWERPOINT COPILOT
LAB 9 THEME · DASHBOARD TO PRESENTATION

Lab 9 — Turn Dashboard Evidence into a Management Story

Maps to	LO4: turn verified dashboard evidence into a professional management presentation
Duration	30 minutes
Tools	Microsoft 365 Copilot · Excel · Word · PowerPoint · Outlook
Mock data	data/Northstar_Work_Orders.xlsx
Course	GenAI for Engineers · v2.4
Prompts	https://tertiarycourses.github.io/IES-GenAI-for-Engineers/prompts/#lab-9

Goal

Turn the dashboard into a Word presentation brief, then into an 8-slide PowerPoint management deck.

What You Will Build

Northstar_Presentation_Brief.docx and an 8-slide Northstar_Management_Draft.pptx.

Prerequisites

- Microsoft 365 account with Copilot available in Word, Excel, PowerPoint and Outlook. Availability depends on the assigned licence and tenant settings; confirm access with the trainer before class.
- Desktop Excel on Windows or Mac. Download this lab folder and open the files straight from its data folder; save any new file in the same folder. All data is fictional.

Data note

Northstar Water Services is a fictional water-pipe maintenance and service company. All service hubs, staff and work orders are synthetic. Use the fixed reporting date 2026-09-30; missing facts remain UNKNOWN. Proposals do not change real assignments. Training email drafts are never sent.

Steps

Step 1. Write the presentation brief. Open data/templates/Northstar_Presentation_Brief_Template.docx in Word and save it as Northstar_Presentation_Brief.docx. In Copilot select + > Upload images and files and choose Northstar_Work_Orders.xlsx from this lab's data folder, then send the prompt. Check the brief shows 120 total, 60 backlog, 50 overdue and 6 unassigned, then save.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
WORD COPILOT:
Use the uploaded Northstar_Work_Orders.xlsx to write a brief for an 8-slide management
presentation. For each slide give a headline, the number that supports it and a one-line
speaker note. Slides: overview, portfolio, site backlog, status and category mix, overdue and
on-time, unassigned jobs, proposed actions, decision needed. Use only numbers from the
workbook.
```

Step 2. Make the deck. Open data/templates/Northstar_Management_Deck_Template.pptx in PowerPoint and save it as Northstar_Management_Draft.pptx. In Copilot select + > Upload images and files and choose Northstar_Presentation_Brief.docx, then send the prompt.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
POWERPOINT COPILOT:
Fill these 8 slides from the uploaded Northstar_Presentation_Brief.docx, one message per
slide. Keep the design, use only numbers from the brief and label actions as proposed.
```

Step 3. Add a real chart. In Excel open data/Northstar_Work_Orders.xlsx, go to the Dashboard, right-click the site chart and select Copy. In PowerPoint paste it on the site backlog slide and save.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
Copy from : Excel Dashboard, site chart
Paste to : the site backlog slide
```

Step 4. Check the deck. Send the prompt in the same PowerPoint chat, fix any wrong number and save.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
POWERPOINT COPILOT:
Check these 8 slides against the uploaded brief. List any number that is wrong and give the
correct number.
```

Copy buttons for every prompt: https://tertiarycourses.github.io/IES-GenAI-for-Engineers/prompts/#lab-9

Test It

Check	Expected result
Brief	8 slide plans; 120 total, 60 backlog, 50 overdue and 6 unassigned.
Deck	8 slides; numbers match the brief; actions labelled proposed.
Chart	The dashboard site chart is on the site backlog slide.

Troubleshooting

If this happens	Fix
Copilot cannot see my file	In Excel, save the file and open Copilot again. In Word, PowerPoint or Outlook, upload the file with + > Upload images and files, and upload it again after you change it.
A number is different from the lab	Clear any slicers or filters, check the table has no extra rows, then ask again in a new chat.
A button or feature is missing	Check you are signed in with your course account and Microsoft 365 is up to date, then tell your trainer.

Challenge

Repeat the task for one different site and explain how the filter scope changes the result. Keep the original verified output.

Reflection

Which evidence proves the output is correct, and which decision still needs a person?